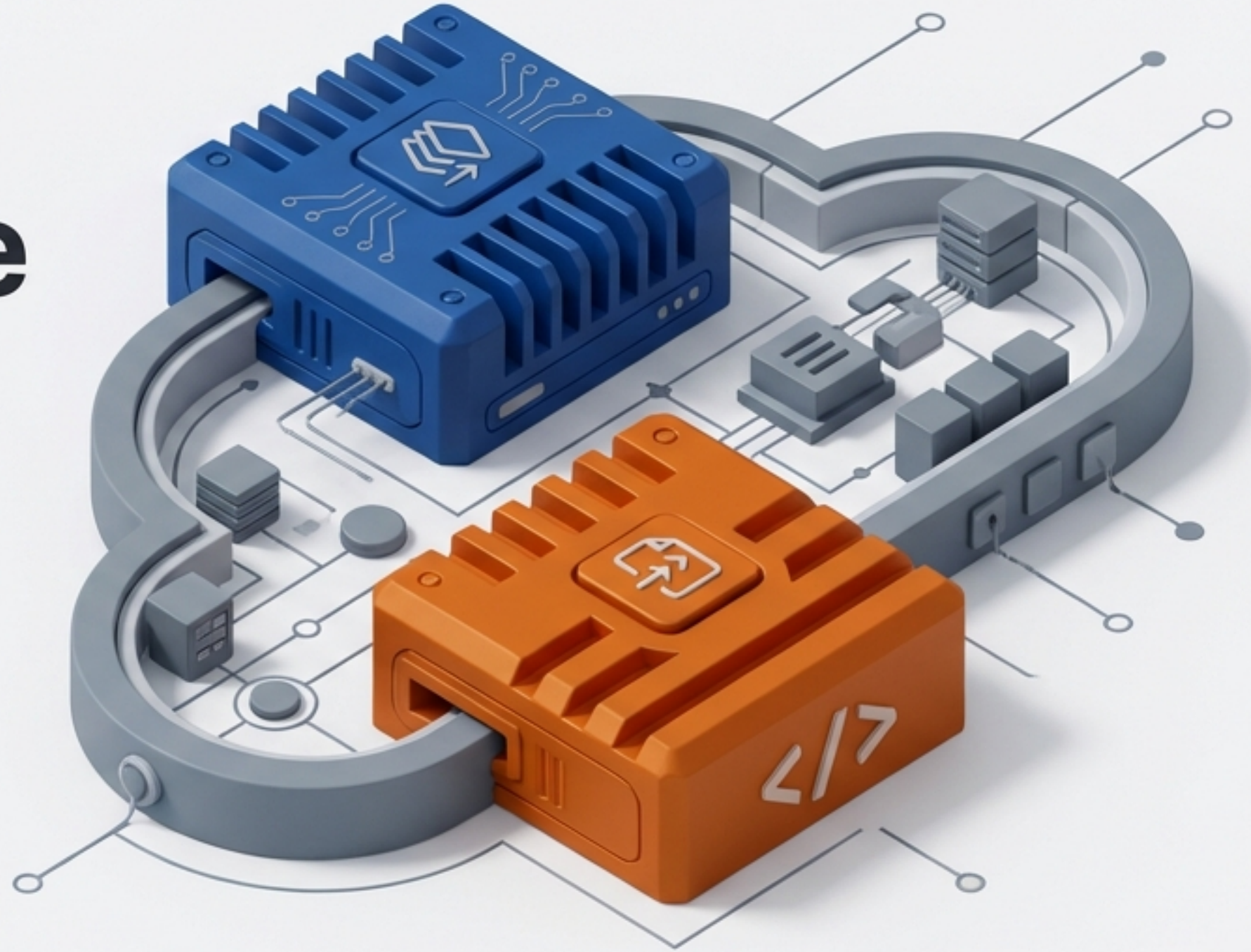


Commercialising API Services on AWS Marketplace

Strategic Path for Cache
Storage & HTML
Transformation Services

DATE: FEBRUARY 2026
STATUS: STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATION
AUDIENCE: PRODUCT & ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP



The Recommendation: A Container-First Commercial Strategy

THE OPPORTUNITY

Leveraging two mature, API-first assets—Cache Storage & HTML Transformation—to drive external revenue and technical learning.



THE STRATEGY

API: REST/gRPC DEPLOYMENT: Docker/K8s

Container Products (Self-Hosted)

DATA SOVEREIGNTY: Client VPC

Launch primarily as Self-Hosted APIs. This minimizes engineering overhead by avoiding complex SaaS billing integration initially and aligns with buyer security needs by keeping data in their VPC.

THE ROADMAP

- ✓ Phase 1: Seller Registration & Limited Listing (Internal Testing)
- ✓ Phase 2: Public Container Launch (The Revenue Engine)
- ✓ Phase 3: Managed SaaS Offering (Future validation dependent)

Defining the Assets and Market Positioning



Cache Storage Service

Filesystem as Database

- Abstracts structured objects, IDs, hashes, and sidecar data.
- Backends: Targets S3, local disk, in-memory, or SQLite.
- Positioning: “Developer Productivity” for LLM workflows and reproducible data pipelines. Not a generic Redis competitor.



HTML Transformation Service

Deterministic Processing

- FastAPI-based service that deconstructs, filters, and reconstructs HTML.
- Use Case: Safety, compliance filtering, and pre-processing.
- Positioning: “Content Safety & Compliance” rather than generic parsing.

The Three Paths to Delivery on AWS Marketplace

Tier 1 SaaS (Managed API)



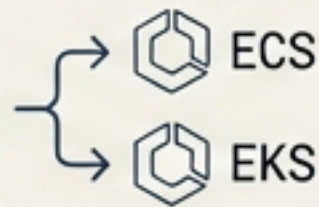
Vendor hosts everything. Highest integration effort (billing, onboarding). Best for pure "managed" experience. Data leaves customer environment.



USER

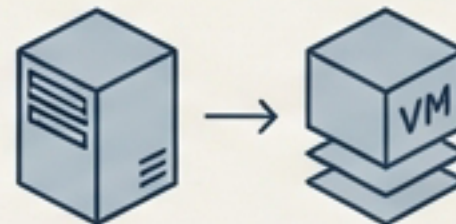
Tier 2 Container (Self-Hosted)

BUYER VPC



Buyer deploys images to ECS/EKS. Data stays in Buyer's VPC. Medium effort. Fits modern DevOps workflows.

BUYER EC2



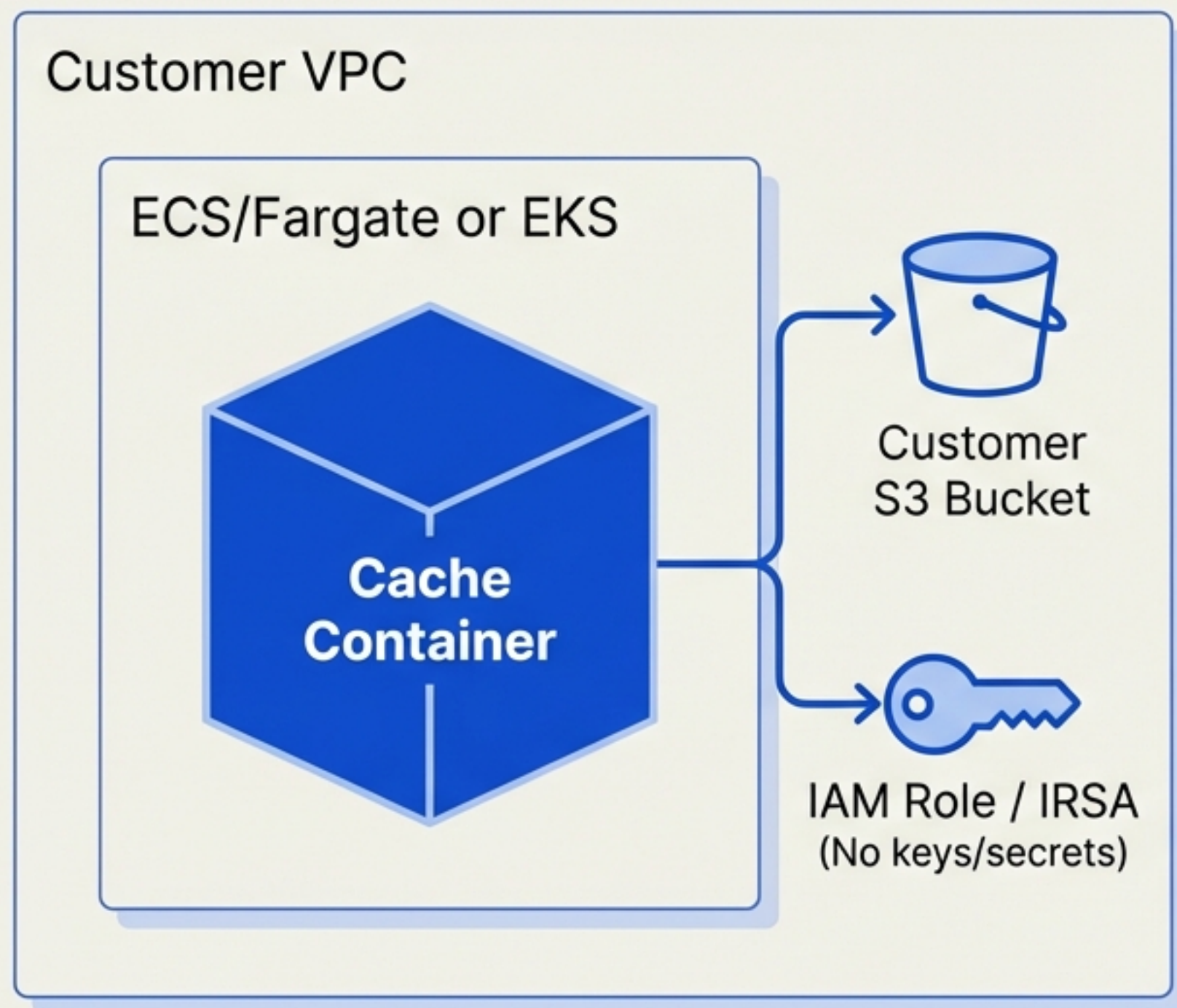
Buyer launches EC2 instances. Best for "virtual appliance" preferences. Less flexible scaling than containers.

Why Container-First is the Winning Strategy

	SaaS	Container	AMI
Data Residency	Data leaves VPC	Stays in Buyer Account (Critical for HTML/Cache) ✓	Stays in Buyer Account ✓
Engineering Lift	High (Billing/Onboarding Flows)	Low/Medium (Standard Packaging) ✓	Medium (Image Baking)
Adoption Fit	Convenience Seekers	Modern DevOps / Kubernetes ✓	Legacy / Appliance

Strategic Verdict: SaaS is viable later, but Container offers the fastest path to revenue with the lowest barrier to entry.

Technical Strategy: Cache Storage Service



Primary Listing: Container Product

Why: Infrastructure component. Customers demand control over IAM policies and storage backend.

Delivery:

- ECS/Fargate templates (Simplicity)
- Helm Charts (Standard EKS flow)

Configuration:

- Pluggable backends (S3, disk, memory) via env vars.
- **CRITICAL:** No embedded credentials. Must use IAM Roles.

Technical Strategy: HTML Transformation Service



Primary Listing: Container Product

Rationale: HTML processing touches sensitive/regulated content. Buyers prefer VPC-contained processing over sending data to external SaaS.

Future Option: SaaS

Viable later for convenience, but requires building a “Developer Console” to issue API keys—unnecessary overhead for Phase 1.

Commercialisation: Pricing & Metering Dimensions

Mechanism: AWS Metering Service (Up to 24 custom dimensions)

Cache Service

Dimensions

- Primary: GB Stored / Month (Data Category)
- Secondary: Operations / Requests (If workload is heavy)

HTML Service

Dimensions

- Primary: Pages Processed or MB Processed
- Secondary: Advanced Transforms (Compute intensity)

Strategy: Start with simple hourly or 'per task' pricing to test market before implementing complex custom metering.

Security Compliance & Engineering Standards



Zero Secrets Policy

- Hardcoded secrets are strictly forbidden.
- Must rely on IAM roles (IRSA/Instance Profiles) for all AWS access.



Vulnerability Management

- Images are scanned layer-by-layer upon upload to AWS Marketplace.
- Must be based on supported Linux distributions.



Patching Strategy

- Establish CI/CD for 'Security Patch Releases' to auto-rebuild and scan.
- Risk: Delisting if non-compliant with new CVEs.



Critical Constraints & Deprecations (2026)



The Helm Deadline: March 1, 2026

AWS Marketplace discontinues 'Quick Launch' for Helm chart deployments on EKS.

Do not rely on Quick Launch.
Provide standard Helm commands.

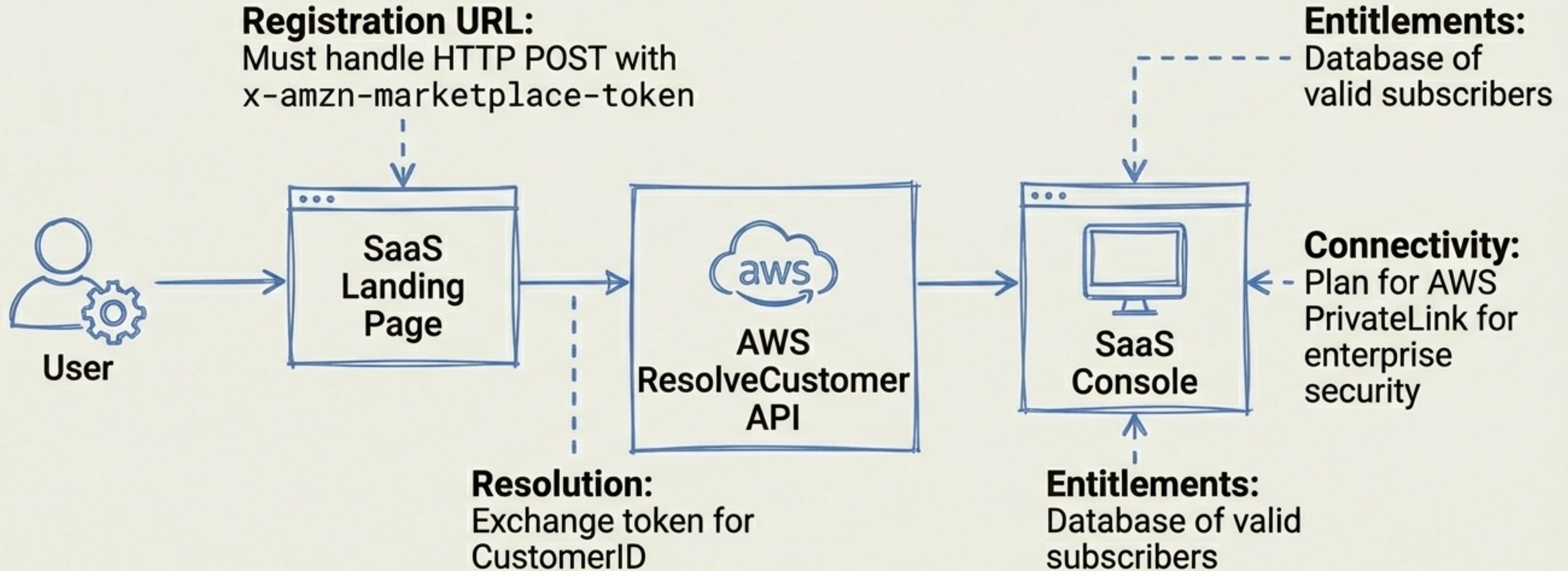


Serverless / SAR Restrictions

New products cannot rely on CloudFormation deploying from Serverless App Repository (SAR).

Avoid 'Serverless' listing types;
stick to Container or pure SaaS.

The Future Phase: Managed SaaS Evolution



Trigger: Execute only once demand for a managed endpoint is validated.

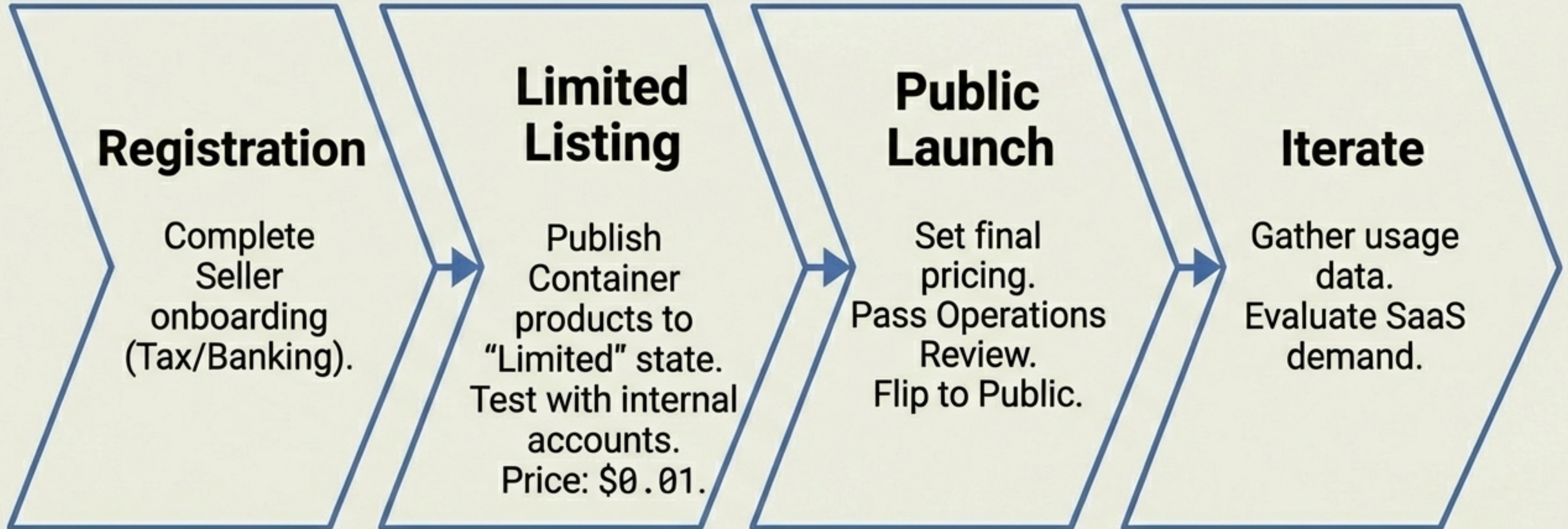
Operational Readiness: The Build Pipeline



Automation Strategy: Treat Marketplace as a deployment target. Use the Catalog API to automate version updates.

Review Loop: Ops review required for moving from Limited to Public.

Go-to-Market Sequence



Summary & Immediate Actions

- 1. Register as AWS Seller immediately.**
- 2. Containerise Cache & HTML services (Remove hardcoded secrets).**
- 3. Define initial 'GB/Request' pricing tiers.**

Final Thought: This Container-First approach balances commercial learning with technical pragmatism, securing a foothold before tackling SaaS complexity.

Appendix: Reference Materials

Container-based product requirements & policies 

AWS Marketplace Metering Service & Custom Dimensions 

SaaS Product Guidelines 

AWS Marketplace Catalog API documentation 

Guide: ResolveCustomer API 

Guide: AWS PrivateLink for SaaS 